KHAN ACADEMY

Initial Mobile Product Evaluation

An Independent Mobile Product Management Portfolio Project

Product detail	Description
Product	Khan Academy
Product website	Khan Academy. org
Platform evaluated	Mobile web on Android
Evaluation approach	Exploratory product evaluation
Primary focus	Users experience, learning continuity,progress visibility, and feature analysis
Project status	Initial evaluation completed

1. Executive Summary

This project presents an exploratory evaluation of Khan Academy's mobile web experience, conducted from the perspective of a learner using an Android device.

The evaluation examined the platform's homepage, course discovery, learning experience, Resume functionality, course progress indicator, learner dashboard, and assessment features.

The initial findings were generally positive. Course discovery and lesson navigation felt straightforward, the Resume feature returned the learner to an existing course, and the platform provided visible course progress and access to learner-related information.

Rather than assuming that the product had usability problems, the evaluation focused on understanding existing functionality, documenting observed behavior, and identifying areas that may warrant further investigation.

The evaluation did not establish a validated user problem or measure the impact of the features on learning outcomes. Further research would be required before making product change recommendations.

Key takeaway: Effective product evaluation begins with understanding the existing experience, distinguishing evidence from assumptions, and identifying what needs to be investigated before proposing a solution.

2. Project Background and Objectives

2.1 Background

Educational mobile experiences must help learners discover relevant content, engage with learning activities, track progress, and return to their studies with minimal friction.

This project was undertaken to practise applying mobile product management principles to an existing educational platform. It provides an opportunity to evaluate product functionality from a user perspective and document findings using a structured, evidence-conscious approach.

2.2 Objectives

The evaluation aimed to:

- Assess the homepage and initial mobile experience.
- Examine course discovery and navigation.
- Review lesson presentation and learning instructions.
- Evaluate the behavior of the Resume feature.
- Observe course progress indicators and dashboard functionality.
- Identify product questions that require additional research.
- Practise documenting findings without overstating the available evidence.

2.3 Scope

The project focused on selected elements of the learner-facing mobile web experience.

It did not include a technical audit, accessibility compliance assessment, competitor benchmarking, formal usability testing, user interviews, quantitative analytics, or controlled experiments.

These activities may be considered in future projects if relevant.

3. Evaluation Methodology

3.1 Approach

The evaluation used direct, exploratory interaction with Khan Academy through a mobile browser on an Android phone.

The evaluator navigated the interface, explored learning-related sections, and observed the behavior of selected features.
The findings were recorded as first-person observations and interpreted from a product management perspective.

3.2 Evidence Classification

To maintain accuracy, findings are separated into three categories:

- Observed: Behavior or interface elements directly encountered during the evaluation.
- Interpretation: A reasonable explanation of how an observed feature may support the learner experience.
- Unverified: Questions or hypotheses that require additional evidence.

This distinction is important because an evaluator's positive experience does not establish that every user will have the same experience or that a feature improves learning outcomes.

3.3 Evaluation Limitations

The evaluation was conducted by one person and reflects the features explored during that session. It was not a formal usability study and did not involve other learners.

No internal product analytics, learning-outcome data, or controlled test results were available. Consequently, the findings should be treated as preliminary rather than representative of the entire user population.

4. Product Evaluation Findings

4.1 Homepage and First Impressions

Observed experience

The homepage communicated the platform's educational purpose and presented opportunities to explore courses. It included sections for students and teachers, examples of the learning experience, and testimonial videos.

The primary calls to action were noticeable on the mobile screen. I selected a call to action and confirmed that it worked.

Product interpretation

The homepage provides an entry point for understanding the product and discovering educational content.

Potential research question

Can learners with different goals and levels of familiarity quickly identify the most relevant starting point?

Finding status: Initial observation completed.

4.2 Course Discovery and Navigation

Observed experience

I found it easy to discover subjects, search for topics, understand course information, and select a course.

Product interpretation

Course discovery appeared straightforward during my evaluation. The experience did not reveal an obvious navigation problem for me.

Potential research question

Would learners with different levels of digital confidence or specific learning goals navigate the course discovery experience equally easily?

Finding status: Initial observation completed; broader usability remains untested.

4.3 Lesson and Learning Experience

Observed experience

Lesson presentation, instructions, practice activities, feedback, and navigation to the next step felt clear and easy to understand. I also noticed an introductory video.

Product interpretation

The lesson experience appeared understandable during the activities I explored.

Evidence limitation

I did not measure knowledge retention, assessment performance, lesson completion rates, or the effectiveness of the instructional design.

Finding status: Initial observation completed.

4.4 Resume Learning Functionality

Observed experience

The platform provided a button labelled “Resume.” When I tapped it, the platform returned me to my course so I could continue learning.

Product interpretation

The Resume feature supports learning continuity by providing a direct route back to an existing learning activity. This may reduce the effort required to locate a course again after leaving the platform.

Evaluation result

The feature worked as expected during my evaluation.

Finding status: Feature behavior observed and tested by the evaluator.

4.5 Course Progress Indicator

Observed experience

A progress bar showed how far I had progressed through a course.

Product interpretation

Visual progress indicators can help learners understand their position within a course and recognize progress already made.

Evidence limitation

I did not independently verify the accuracy of the indicator or test how other learners interpret it.

Finding status: Progress indicator observed; effectiveness not measured.

4.6 Personal Learner Dashboard

Observed experience

The learner dashboard provided access to my profile, personal courses, badges, and other learner-related features. I also observed learning progress.

Product interpretation

The dashboard brings together learner-related information and provides access to personal learning content and achievements.

Badges may recognize achievements, but their effect on motivation was not evaluated.

Potential research question

How do learners use dashboard information to monitor progress, review achievements, and decide what to study next?

Finding status: Dashboard features observed; their impact on learner behavior remains unverified.

4.7 Tests and Assessments

Observed experience

I noticed a test within the platform.

Product interpretation

Assessment functionality can give learners opportunities to practise or demonstrate their understanding.

Evidence limitation

I did not explore the test in enough detail to determine its exact purpose, scoring behavior, feedback mechanism, or relationship to course progress.

Finding status: Feature identified but not evaluated in depth.

5. Consolidated Findings

Product Area	Observations	Evaluation Status
Resume functionality	Returned the learner to the course	Tested
Progress indicator	Displayed progress through a course.	Observed
Learners dashboard	Included profile, personal courses, badges, and other features	Explored
Tests and assessments	A test was noticed, but its functionality was not examined in depth.	Partially explored
Next-learning guidance	Behavior after completing a lesson was not verified	Open question
Personalized recommendations	Their presentation and effectiveness were not established	Open question

Interpretation: The evaluation identified several existing features that appear to support navigation, learning continuity, and progress visibility. It did not establish that these features are deficient or that a new feature is necessary.

6. Product Management Analysis

6.1 Learning Continuity

The Resume feature provides a direct way to return to an existing course.

From a product perspective, this represents a useful continuity mechanism. However, the evaluation did not measure how frequently learners use it or whether it changes course completion rates.

6.2 Progress Visibility

The course progress bar and dashboard make learning progress visible to the evaluator.

Progress visibility can help learners understand where they are in a learning journey. Further investigation would be needed to establish whether the information is sufficiently clear and actionable for different users.

6.3 Learner Information and Achievements

The dashboard consolidates profile information, personal courses, badges, and other features.

This creates a central place for learners to access account-related and learning-related information. Whether this arrangement helps learners make better learning decisions remains an open question.

6.4 Product Decisions Should Follow Evidence

A key product management lesson from this evaluation is that an existing feature should not be redesigned simply because a new idea is available.

The Resume feature and progress indicator appeared to work as expected during the review. A responsible next step would be to investigate unmet user needs before recommending changes to these or other features.

7. Potential Areas for Further Investigation

The following are research opportunities, not confirmed product problems.

7.1 Choosing the Next Learning Activity

Research question: After a learner finishes a lesson or returns to a course, how clearly does the platform communicate the next available learning activity?

This question remains unanswered because the post-lesson experience was not observed directly.

7.2 Understanding Progress Information

Research question: Do learners understand what their course progress indicator represents, and do they use it to plan their learning?

The presence of a progress indicator is confirmed by this evaluation. Its clarity and influence on learner decisions have not been measured.

7.3 Assessment Feedback

Research question: How does the test provide feedback, and how easily can learners understand what to do after completing it?

The assessment feature was noticed but not examined in sufficient depth.

7.4 Personalized Learning Guidance

Research hypothesis: Some learners may need clearer guidance on what to study next based on their goals, current knowledge, and progress.

This hypothesis has not been validated. Khan Academy already provides course and progress-related functionality, so further research should establish whether existing guidance meets learners' needs before any new solution is proposed.

8. Recommended Next Steps

If this project is extended into a full product management case study, the next stages should be:

1. Further product exploration: Examine the post-lesson experience, assessment feedback, and available learning guidance.
2. User research: Interview or survey learners about how they choose courses, monitor progress, and decide what to study next.
3. Problem validation: Identify whether a meaningful and recurring user problem exists.
4. Prioritization: Assess any validated problem in terms of user impact, frequency, and feasibility.
5. Solution proposal: Develop a product change only if the evidence supports one.
6. Success measurement: Define appropriate metrics and a testing plan for evaluating the proposed change.

These activities are proposed next steps. They have not been completed as part of this initial evaluation.

9. Skills Demonstrated

This project provides evidence of introductory practice in:

- Mobile product evaluation.
- Exploratory user experience analysis.
- Product feature assessment.
- User journey observation.
- Evidence-based documentation.
- Distinguishing observations from interpretations and hypotheses.
- Research question development.
- Preliminary product opportunity analysis.

The project demonstrates foundational practice rather than mastery of the entire mobile product management lifecycle.

10. Limitations and Considerations

The findings should be interpreted within the following limitations:

1. The evaluation was conducted by one person.
2. The results reflect personal experience and are not representative user research.
3. No interviews or surveys were conducted.
4. Internal product analytics were unavailable.
5. Learning outcomes and feature effectiveness were not measured.
6. The assessment feature was not explored in depth.
7. The post-lesson experience and personalized learning guidance remain unverified.
8. No product solution was developed or tested.

Acknowledging these limitations improves the credibility of the project and helps prevent unsupported product recommendations.

11. Conclusion

This independent evaluation examined selected parts of Khan Academy's mobile web experience, including the homepage, course discovery, lesson presentation, Resume functionality, progress indicator, learner dashboard, and test functionality.

The features explored generally worked well during my evaluation. Course discovery and lesson navigation felt straightforward, the Resume feature returned me to my course, and the platform displayed progress and learner-related information.

The evaluation did not identify a validated user problem, establish the effectiveness of the features for the broader learner population, or test a product solution.

The main outcome is a structured record of the existing experience, preliminary product interpretations, and research questions that could inform future work.

The project demonstrates an evidence-conscious approach to mobile product management: understand the product, document what is observed, acknowledge what remains unknown, and investigate user needs before recommending changes.

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12. Project Reflection: What I Learned

This project provided practical experience in several foundational mobile product management skills.

Product observation and feature analysis: I examined existing functionality and considered the purpose each feature serves in the learner experience.

Mobile UX evaluation: I assessed course discovery, lesson navigation, Resume functionality, progress visibility, and the learner dashboard.

Evidence-based documentation: I practised recording actual observations without inventing product problems.

Critical thinking: I distinguished direct observations from interpretations and unvalidated hypotheses.

Research planning: I identified questions that would require additional investigation before a product decision could be justified.

Key Learning

A positive personal experience does not prove that a product works perfectly for every learner. Equally, a product manager should not invent a problem simply to justify a proposed solution.

Effective product management requires understanding existing functionality, identifying user needs, validating problems, and using evidence to guide product decisions.

Project Status

Completed: Initial exploratory mobile product evaluation and documentation of observations.

Not completed: Formal user research, problem validation, solution design, and solution testing.

Skills Practised

Mobile Product Management · UX Evaluation · Product Analysis · Evidence-Based Decision-Making · Research Planning

Project type: Independent learning and portfolio project.